

The Three Kinds of Worship and the Baptism of Geography

Open to 1 Corinthians 11, and put a marker near the end of Ephesians 5. Then make a bet that we will get there. Hallelujah, Jesus.

There are basically three kinds of worship. One is worship, another is praise, and the last is celebration. Celebration is when your body gets involved and wants to jump, run, and dance. Praise is generally when you are praising and singing songs together about the works of God and who He is. Praise goes well with confession.

But the one that has to do with you on a more personal level is worship. Worship is adoration, and that is you to Him. It is your heart to His. It is more along the lines of, "I love You. I glorify You. I magnify You. I exalt You. I extol You. I lift You up." It is you toward Him, and that is the one we are mostly going to be looking at.

That is the one the Holy Ghost dropped me off at. It probably changed my life as drastically as anything.

We will call this worship on a personal level. When we are going through these hours, somebody else may be leading, playing, or singing. You can sing along if you want, or you can break off into private worship, using your own words, choosing your own words to tell Him how much you love Him, adore Him, and glorify Him.

When we are in this long three-hour time, you do not have to stay in your chair. You can get up and wander around while you worship Him, adore Him, and pray.

One thing with private worship, and really any kind of worship, is that there has to be participation. There is a "be still and know that He is God." There is sitting quietly in His presence and listening. But that is not exactly why we are gathering together. We are gathering to learn mostly about private worship: what it will do to your life and what it will add to your walk.

If you do it and stay with it, it will add a whole dimension to your walk. It is absolutely incredible.

I thought private worship was just for worship leaders because I had no idea what it would do to teaching. I had no idea what it would do to praying for people outside of church. I had no idea what it would do to prayer cloths or praying for someone over the phone.

Private worship has everything to do with that anointing that comes and belongs to the believer, not the office. I am not talking about the mighty apostle, prophet, evangelist, miracles, healings, or the gifts you identify those offices with. I am talking about the anointing of the believer, Joe Public, Mary Wallpaper, the domestic vacuum queen.

These signs shall follow them that believe. They shall lay hands on the sick, and the sick shall recover. We are talking about a presence of God that wants to come and take up residency in the geographical area you walk in.

I was a year overdue. The Holy Ghost, praying in tongues, the revelation gift, tried to drop me off on the worship limb a year before I broke in.

Did I do it? No.

I went with the youth group to Oklahoma City to a passion play. It was a good play. Angels flew on wires. Hell was hot. Everybody had talent. Nobody missed a note or key. The whole thing was impeccable. There was just one problem: no anointing.

On the way home, I was musing before God, communing in my heart. I said, "What would it take to get an anointing into something like that?"

He came right back and said, "You could find out if you go home and worship Me all night."

Did I? No. I thought it was just a suggestion, like an answer to a question.

A year went by, and I was standing right here with my hands up while someone was ministering in a prayer line. All of a sudden, I felt a breeze come through. I found out later I was the only one who had the experience. It blew me down by myself. At the time, I did not know if I was going up or down. When I found myself on the floor, I knew where I had gone.

I got so far out in the Spirit that He began to talk to me and give me instruction. He knows if He gives me instruction, I know what instructions are. You will find me dead at the foot of Instruction Mountain rather than stopped.

I was lying there, and He said, "You do not know anything about worship."

I started protesting. I was on the ninth day of a fast. He said, "You do not know anything about worship."

I said, "Okay. What do I do about fasting?"

He said, "I did not tell you not to fast. But fasting cannot give you what worship can, and worship cannot give you what fasting can."

He told me something hard. I broke the fast. But then He said, "Many men and women of God have majored on one key. Many of them claim, 'It is my ministry to teach on that key.' But if they only major on one key, only one door is unlocked, and only that benefit is what they have. Even if they do not teach on the other keys, they are supposed to use them to unlock the things of God."

Some just worship. Others go far over on fasting. Others major on other keys. I started feeling a little guilty because people say I go overboard on praying in tongues. But the guilt lasted about a tenth of a second.

He knew what I was thinking and immediately said, "Fortunately, the one you gave yourself to is a revelation gift and is producing all the other ones."

So I was a year late, but He dropped me off on the worship limb.

He said, "You do not know anything about worship." I was thinking, "Yes, I do."

He told me how many hours to worship, with a two-hour variation. "Not less than this, and up to this much. You can do more if you like, but try to get this much, and not less than this."

So I went into my sound booth, closed the door, turned all the lights out, with no music and no help. It was me, myself, and I, and God was in there.

Why did I not want music? Because I did not want any help or aid whatsoever. I wanted to break in to worship. You cannot always have music. What if a big native breaks your little machine out in the jungle? What if you are thrown in prison, and every time you say, "I love You, Jesus," someone hits you with a chain? Is that conducive to worship? It is conducive to crying, I can tell you that.

I wanted to break in.

After about two or three months, right around one camp meeting and then another, I found out that everything He is in that presence. First He started coming for short times. At first, it was harder than anything just to stay in. After a while, He started coming and visiting me for periods of time. Then He came and stayed longer and longer.

After He stayed longer, I found out that everything He is in that presence, the one you break into in private worship.

On the way back from Oklahoma City, I had a vision. I saw a rock land in a pond. One ripple moved from the rock, then another followed it. These ripples followed each other all the way to every nook and cranny separated from the main pond.

I said, "What is this?"

When He was able to answer me, He said, "The first wave fills your spirit with My presence. If you keep going, the second wave baptizes your sense man, the emotional realms of the soul. If you keep going, you will have a Smith Wigglesworth experience, where I baptize the geography you walk in."

People tried to get past Wigglesworth. How would you like still to be a plumber and have townspeople stand on the railroad track so the train cannot go through because you are on it, then drag you off and refuse to let the train go until you give them a miracle service while you are still a plumber?

People would walk by and say, "My God, man, you convict me of my sins," and break down and weep like babies. Why? Baptism of geography. It comes and rests around you, and people know it.

That is when I found out everything He is in that presence.

These signs will follow Mary Wallpaper and Joe Public. These signs will follow them that believe.

I first noticed it when I went to Phoenix, Arizona, to minister for an old friend in a miracle service. I ministered until I was so tired, and they took me in the back to recover. I was tired from travel and ministry. I had been worshiping privately approximately three months.

That was the night it showed up.

The pastor's wife came back. She had jammed her thumb, and it had not worked in a couple of years. She could not bend it very far.

She said, "Would you pray for me?"

I said, "Yes, ma'am."

I started to reach out to bend it and see how far it would go. Do not ask me why we do that. What difference does it make? But I started to test it. When my hand went toward it, He came in. It was the same familiar presence, not the anointing that had come in the service on my gift. That one usually goes home when you do.

He filled the room. I put my hand on her thumb and started to bend it while saying the name of Jesus. I only got about half of it out because her thumb bent all the way over under the pressure I put on it.

She said, "Oh, my God!"

I was as shocked as she was, but I did not want to admit it. I acted like I knew what I was doing.

Then an elder's child came running over. He had been born blind in one eye. I put my hand over his eye, and the same thing came. He took my hand off his eye and was looking back at me. He ran into the auditorium screaming, and a commotion broke out.

I was trying to figure this out. First your spirit, then the baptism of the senses.

Ephesians 5 talks about that baptism of the senses:

"Be not drunk with wine, wherein is excess;
but be filled with the Spirit;
Speaking to yourselves in psalms and hymns and spiritual songs,
singing and making melody in your heart to the Lord."

What part of an alcoholic does alcohol affect? The senses. Does it impair them? Yes. A man after two drinks may think he can fight the governor of California at the end of the bar. He is not evaluating things in the light they exist in. His senses have been impaired by alcohol, and he is about to get the beating of his life.

But what did Paul say? Do not be drunk with wine, but be filled with the Spirit. How? Ministering to yourself in psalms, hymns, and spiritual songs.

You are not moving God. What does He have to do to convince you that He wants to move? It is not His fellowship with you that is lacking. His has always been available. It is your fellowship with Him.

Now you are going to stay in His presence and tell Him how much you love Him until you start this rock-in-the-pond baptism. When it gets to your senses, your senses are going to be impaired. This is how: God will say, "I want to do this miracle for you." Your senses used to say, "He cannot!" But now that your senses are coming under the baptism of His presence in worship, they start agreeing with what you are saying that you cannot see.

The pendulum moves to the side of faith because you are having trouble doubting. Your senses are being impaired. You are being baptized in the new wine.

It makes a person wonder why he ever fell out of worship. Or maybe why he never got in.

In our camp meeting here, somebody brought a Baptist lady who had a brace on her arm. The lady who brought her wanted prayer, but the Baptist lady would not wait. She said, "I want to go home right now."

I asked them to bring her back to talk to me. I said, "Won't you just wait? Nobody will bother you."

She said, "No, I want to go right now."

I looked down and saw the brace. "What happened to your arm?"

She said, "It is cracked."

"Does it hurt?"

"Oh, yes."

I said, "Do you mind if I pray for you? You are not going to fall down. I am not going to go wild. I am not going to yell. Then you can go."

She said, "Okay."

I reached up gently and said, "Jesus. Jesus. Do it."

She looked at me strangely and went home. The next day she woke up, and all the pain was gone from her arm, and it was mobile. She was a schoolteacher. She called her friend and said, "My arm does not hurt. I told the other teachers, 'They are really funny people, but God hears them.'"

Those were good miracles from the anointing of the believer, from private worship. It was the same presence that came and stayed from me pounding my flesh, pounding my soul, bringing myself under subjection hour after hour to tell Him what I think about Him. It was not changing God. It was changing me.

I already had a good anointing that came on my gift. But this one goes into homes, hospitals, and over the telephone. This thing goes everywhere.

In private worship, you have to participate with God. You are welcome to come on Friday nights and sit down and enjoy the presence if that is what you want. You can sit and read your Bible or pray in tongues and enjoy the presence that is here.

But if you want to join what the rest of us are breaking into, I want to find out what happens when a person worships God long enough to break through to the other side of the flesh and let the baptism begin: first your spirit, then your sense man, and finally your geography, until He comes into the room you are in and everybody knows it.

I had no idea private worship was for the worship gift only. I thought it was to enhance worship leaders. But you have no idea what it will do to your teaching gift or witnessing gift. When you witness, an anointing can come and you do not have to think about what to say. You have no idea what invoking His presence to come and stay with you on purpose will do to that gift. Not only will you testify of Jesus; He will perform for you.

Is it worth the hours it takes? You have your whole life ahead of you. You tell me.

When you come here for these four hours, I want to teach you how to couple private worship with confession. I want to teach you how you and Him lock in worship while music is going on, and how we join corporately and worship Him together.

One thing this will do is launch you into a private lifestyle. After He starts the baptism and comes as He has never come before, it will pull you into private times. You have no idea what deliberate, on-purpose time with Him, telling Him how much you love Him hour after hour, will do.

Today I was going to get into Ephesians 5 and show you what worship has to do with His covering and Jesus' provision for you.

When you break into private worship until His presence comes in any amount, you begin to find where the real roots of blessing are rooted. Ephesians 5 says He is the head of the church and the Savior of the body. Head means covering, and Savior includes not only Savior out of sin, but provider of righteousness, healing, inheritance, and supply.

He is the covering of the church and the provider of the body. The word for head includes covering and provider. That is why Paul says a man prophesying or praying with his head covered dishonors his head. He dishonors Christ because a woman has been forced to rise up and cover his life and provide for it. That is insulting to Christ because it insinuates that Christ has not met the need.

What do you think will happen when you get to know Him so thoroughly that you have no trouble understanding Him as provider?

In Ephesians 5, Paul says he is talking about marriage between a man and woman, but what he is really talking about is the relationship Christ has with the church. The man is the head of the woman, meaning provider and covering. It is an insult when a woman has to cover a man, because it insinuates Christ has not met the need.

So what do you think private worship will do for your provision when this relationship between Christ and the church is being compared to the relationship between a man and a woman?

When was the last time you lifted your hands for an hour and said, "I do not want anything. I am just going to sit here and tell You, me to You, how much I love You"? Do you have any idea what will begin to happen?

The year I broke through, I left here and went to Cleveland, Tennessee. One week turned into six. Just from Lee College alone, we sent four major miracles back. In Bakersfield at the Bible college, six people came in on crutches and walkers, and six left without them.

You say, "I am nobody."

Oh yes, you are.

You can sit here and read or pray in tongues. But for true worship to take place, it is not how loud you shout or how quietly you talk. What is in your heart must be articulated in words and told to Him.

It does not have to be flowery or full of big words. Why not try, "I just want to tell You I love You. I glorify You. I magnify You." It is not about flowery words; it is about stopping and pouring everything you are into each statement of adoration.

When we only have four hours like tonight, do not let your mind turn your mouth loose into lip service. You may start worshiping, and after a couple of hours, especially if there is no heavy anointing spurring you on, your mind may wander off to solve yesterday's problems while your mouth keeps saying, "I love You." That is lip service.

Eventually, if you spend hours and hours in private worship and hit those times, the law of confession will kick in. Your mind can wander while you are saying, "I love You," and eventually your soul will transform to what you are saying. It may take longer, but He will start coming anyway.

But when we only have a few hours, practice His presence. If your soul walks down the street to solve a problem, bring it back. Say, "I am in the presence of a King. I am going to offer protocol. I am going to bring this King a gift, and it is me. Here I am. I am all You want, and I know You want me."

In my prayer closet, I practiced His presence. My mind wandered off a hundred times. I would go get it and bring it back. What a fight. But when He started coming, there was no going to get my mind. It became suspended in His presence.

I would get a big hot cup of tea, set it there, take a little sip, and go back in: "I love You. I worship You. I really do. I glorify and magnify You." Those were the days when His presence was coming and staying longer and longer. Sometimes after I had worshiped for what felt like a few minutes, I would reach over for my tea and it would be cold. I had been lost for two hours.

When you are worshipping and people around you look like they are feeling things while you are not, do not think you are not getting through. In fact, you are getting through more than when He is dancing on your head, because you would not have the dancing on your head if you had not plowed through the flesh.

All the angels of heaven gather. Your flesh cannot stop you. Pharaoh is behind you, the Red Sea is in front of you, the desert is on both sides, but you raise your hands like none of it exists and say, "Have I told You today that I love You?"

Heaven says, "We have a hot one here. Nothing else could go wrong, and he will not quit worshipping. He cannot feel anything. It feels like he is going to die. It feels like the end of the world, but he will not stop."

When you cannot feel anything and are fighting all hell, that is when you are plowing. One day you will feel more than you can handle, but not unless you go through this.

You can read, pray in tongues, or sit, but if you are going to appropriate this key and have the benefits of a baptism of your geography and your sense man, you have to start somewhere. I am not just talking about in a service. Most of what we get in a service is a grace blessing. We come world-weary, the song leader does his best to pull us up, and after a while God in His grace gives us feelings for a while.

But generally, when you log on for three or four hours, the feelings will vacate, and you will end up with flesh and a whole lot of things. Do not stop. You are going to make it.

When He starts coming and staying longer and longer, you can hardly get into someone's presence and lift your hands without Him coming.

When I first came out of that closet, Gary had a friend, a truck driver, with a pack of cigarettes in his pocket. I asked him to come over. He stood there, and when I lifted my hands to pray, he leaned back about forty-five degrees. I took my hands back, and he came forward. It reminded me of what had happened to me in the closet. So I lifted my hands again, and he leaned back. I said, "What are you doing?"

He said, "Something is pushing on me."

It was geography. It is not just for us.

I would take these hours and look forward to the next Friday. I would make a decision to sacrifice something else and pick up another hour a day along the way. If I were you, I would get into this thing in the first quarter of this year and watch how it turns out.

Remember, if you continue in this worship, it is also going to change your finances.

You can sing what they are singing, or you can give yourself over to private worship. You can walk, get down by your chair, or stay where you are. Just do not stop worshiping Him. You have to participate. There has to be a release of the statement.

Remember what God prophesied through me about loving Him. He said, "I cannot love Myself in you for you."

Your new nature, your spirit, has the capacity to develop in the love of God until this love becomes part of your new creation, part of you, part of who you are. Although it is God's love, it is resident in you because it is a product of the new creation and the life that came from your Father. His love is developed independently in you as an individual. When you yield all you are to His love, and that compassion begins to build in you, then you turn and give it back to Him.

That is what He was talking about. "I cannot love Myself in you for you." It has to come from you.

So when you make statements of adoration, say, "I glorify and love You and magnify You. You are not a man that You can lie. You exalted Your Word above Your name. Heaven and earth pass away, but Your Word abides forever. I have what I say. I call myself dead, that I may separate to You all the glory and praise. I glorify and magnify You."

Tell Him how much you love Him. Then at the end, say, "The blind see, the lame walk, the deaf hear, and the poor have this gospel preached to them." Then you may cycle it again and worship Him another whole hour just for doing that.